

Gigabyte G-MAX N501

This Centrino notebook features an Intel Pentium M 1.6 GHz processor, 256 MB of DDR RAM and a 40 GB hard disk. The 15-inch 1024 x 768 TFT colour LCD display appears surprisingly large due to the thin borders.

Connectivity options are good—it supports infrared, Wi-Fi 802.11 B/G, 10/100 Mbps LAN, and a 56 Kbps modem. There are three USB ports, a FireWire port, a serial port, and support for SD cards too.

It scored a decent 18.4 in the Business WinStone 2004 test, and can handle office applications well. Battery life, though, was a mediocre two hours and 41 mins.

Company **Gigabyte Technology (India) Ltd**

Price **Rs 47,750 (Local levies extra)**

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Web site **www.giga-byte.com**

Rating



Palm LifeDrive Mobile Manager

Not Converged Enough

In this world of convergence, Palm has decided to buck the trend with the LifeDrive. It's one of the rare handhelds to not include cell phone features.

The LifeDrive is brilliant at what it does, though, and is the first ever microdrive-based PDA—but to have a handheld that does amazing things and not be able to make a call means you'll have to carry two devices.

The device looks sleek with a brushed, muted aluminium finish, a big screen—a 320 x 480 TFT touch screen, and four dedicated buttons for music, photos, home (main menu) and file browser, along with four-way navigation and a centre click button.

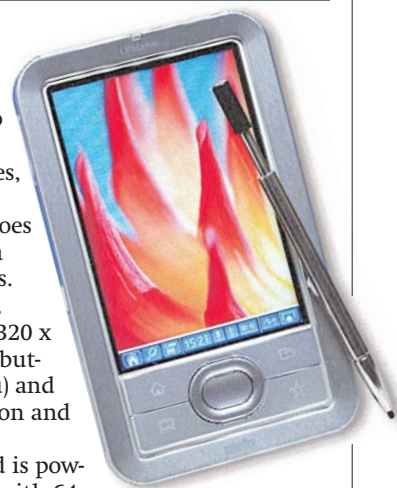
It runs on the Palm OS 5.4 Garnet, and is powered by a 416 MHz Intel XScale processor, with 64 MB of onboard RAM and a 4 GB hard disk. Not surprisingly, it is underpowered, and the interface is sluggish.

Available from **The Gadget Boy (Inorbit Mall, Malad, Mumbai)**

Price **Rs 26,500**

Phone **022-56880270** Web site **www.palm.com**

Rating



New & Notable

Samsung SGH-D500

Now That's A Swiss Army Knife!

Measuring 93.5 x 45.7 x 23.6 mm and tipping the scales at just 99 gms, the D500 is the latest head-turner from Samsung. A tri-band GPRS mobile phone, the D500 boasts of features like a slide-out keypad, MP3 playback, external speakers and a 1.3 megapixel camera with flash.

Encased in a beautiful, glossy black casing, the device sports a 176 x 220 LCD that can display 262,144 colours. Apart from the screen, the front fascia includes a four-way navigation key with a centre-click button, two soft keys, Send and Call End keys and a Cancel button.

The left side of the phone has a conjoined volume control key and an IR port, while the right side has a dedicated camera key and a port to connect the external speaker. The bottom of the phone slides out to reveal the backlit 12-key numpad and the camera at the rear. You also find a self-portrait mirror and the flash next to the camera at the rear.

Unique features include support for seven Indian regional languages: Hindi, Marathi, Tamil, Bengali, Punjabi, Gujarati and Kannada. Connectivity options include Bluetooth, USB and SyncML, apart from Infrared.

Three Java games—*Forgotten Warrior*, *Freekick* and *Arch Angel* are pre-loaded. Memory capacity is 96MB, shared dynamically between applications. You cannot expand the memory, however.



The 1.3 megapixel camera can capture stills at 1280 x 1024, 1152 x 864, 640 x 480, 320 x 240, 176 x 144, and 128 x 96 resolutions with three quality settings. The shooting mode can be set to Single, Multi, Mosaic or Night. ISO setting can be kept at Auto or set to speeds of 100, 200 or 400. The flash can be switched Off or set to Auto, Permanently On or Shoot Only. Video can be captured in 3gp format at 176 x 144, 160 x 120 or 128 x 96 resolutions, with three quality options.

The phone provides a standard icon-based menu, accessible using the soft-key and the navigation button. The size of the keys is a bit of an issue, though, and you will need to use the tips of your fingers to operate. The slider can be operated using one hand.

MP3 playback is decent with the inbuilt speaker, and even better with the external speaker module. The supplied speaker is a tiny conical device that plugs in to the side of the phone, and is also a speakerphone.

On the whole, the phone is great for users who want a sleek camera phone with high flaunt value.

Company **Samsung India Electronics**

Price **Rs 21,399**

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Rating

